

work dynamically assigns indexing features to other connected nodes or peers based on criteria such as machine uptime, data availability and system performance. These peers are called Supernodes and it is to these machines that other peers or nodes are connected. There are a large number of supernodes present on a network at any given time and clients or peers connect to any available Supernode irrespective of the priority of the client. As long as there is a Supernode available on the network, you can be connected. The principle of having a Supernode on the network increases scalability without affecting network performance and also catering to a large number of users at the same time.

Kazaa Vs. Napster

The difference between download options offered by Kazaa and Napster was massive. While Napster only indulged in song swapping, Kazaa was a virtual pirate bay. Any application-music, video, documents-that was shared on a computer could be accessed (as long as the data was kept in “My Shared Folder” in the Kazaa directory. Plus, an improvement in the network performance due to a decentralised system allowed users to download anything they wanted with ease.

Users who could understand file-sharing had a lethal and potent software at their disposal, which would get them everything that they wanted without paying a penny in the process (of course, not considering the Internet access charges). Suddenly, everything was on the Internet. You want Windows XP, connect and download it. You want Shrek the movie, connect and download it. You want Sheryl Crow’s music, connect and download! Everyone had everything and the share and share alike adage was catching on like bushfire.

What also got Kazaa going was a deluge of Web sites that were dedicated on making Kazaa the only place to get software and other stuff. Links on these websites could be clicked on and would be automatically added to the software saving users the pain of sifting through junk results thrown up by the internal search in Kazaa.

Nevertheless, there was an inherent problem that users were